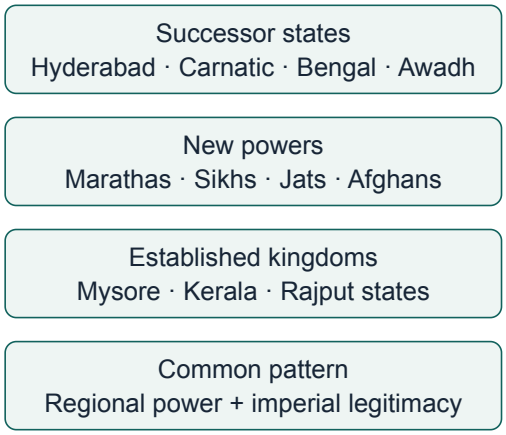
Rise of Autonomous States

1. Transformation of the polity

- Mughal decline enabled **regional autonomy**, not a complete absence of government. Rulers often retained imperial titles, confirmation, coinage/orders and occasional tribute while exercising independent power.
- **Successor states:** Hyderabad, Carnatic, Bengal, Awadh—Mughal provincial authorities asserting autonomy.
- **New states/powers:** Marathas, Sikhs, Jats, Afghans—local mobilisation and military expansion.
- **Established autonomous kingdoms:** Mysore, Kerala kingdoms and Rajput states—distinct pre-existing trajectories; “independent” is not a claim that none ever had a Mughal connection.
- Strong provincial administration and prosperous regional economies coexisted with declining Delhi authority. No single power sustainably replaced the Mughals across India.



Three trajectories of regional State-building; imperial legitimacy often survived.

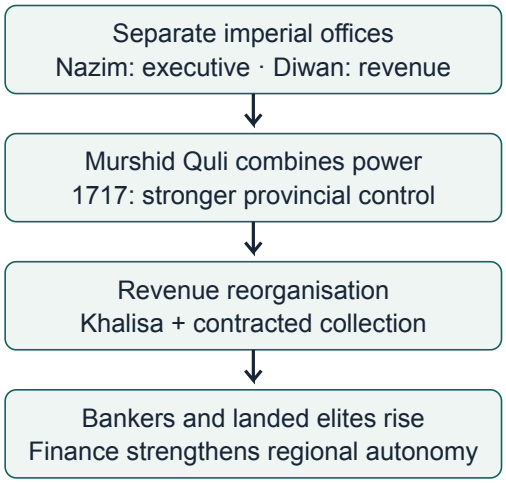
2. Hyderabad and Carnatic

- **Hyderabad, 1724:** founded by **Qamar-ud-din Siddiqi / Chin Qilich Khan / Nizam-ul-Mulk / Asaf Jah**, a Turani noble. Deccan governorship **1713**; Mughal wazir **1722–24**; founder ruled until **1748**.
- Departed faction-ridden Delhi; defeated **Mubariz Khan at Shakar Kheda, October 1724**. Founded **Asaf Jahi dynasty** without formally repudiating Mughal sovereignty.
- Reformed revenue/administration, conducted wars/treaties/appointments independently; appointed Hindus, including **Puran Chand as diwan**. Accompanied Muhammad Shah against Nadir at **Karnal, 1739**.
- Sought to redirect Maratha expansion northward. **1748 succession dispute: son Nasir Jung versus grandson Muzaffar Jung**; Dupleix supported Muzaffar, illustrating French intervention through local rivalries.
- **Carnatic = Coromandel Coast and hinterland; capital Arcot**. Nawab subordinate in theory to Deccan Nizam, increasingly autonomous in practice.
- **Saadatullah Khan (1710–32)** nominated nephew **Dost Ali (1732–40)** without Nizam's prior approval. Marathas killed Dost Ali in **1740** and captured son-in-law **Chanda Sahib**, taken to Satara.

- Succession conflict created openings for French/English; **Carnatic Wars, 1746–63**. Do not confuse the historic Carnatic region with modern Karnataka State.

3. Bengal: administration, revenue and banking

- Province covered **Bengal, Bihar, Orissa**. **Subah** → **sarkar** → **pargana**; faujdars and local zamindars exercised important authority.
- **Nazim/subahdar:** executive, military and civil/criminal administration; **diwan:** revenue/finance. Separate imperial appointment/accountability originally checked concentration of power.
- Other offices: **bakshi—military paymaster; kotwal—police; qazi—justice; waqai-navis—news/reporting**.
- **Murshid Quli Khan / Muhammad Hadi:** Bengal diwan from **1700**; combined governorship and revenue power in **1717**; ruled **1717–27**. Associated with transfer of administrative centre from **Dhaka to Murshidabad**.
- Resumed/reassigned jagirs, enlarged **khalisa** revenue and used **ijarah/malzamini**, backed by contractor security bonds. Many Hindu officials/revenue contractors rose; do not assume every older zamindar disappeared.
- **Khalisa:** revenue directly for State treasury. **Jagir:** revenue assignment. **Ijarah:** contracted revenue collection. These are distinct arrangements, not identical land-ownership categories.
- Stricter collections supported provincial finance but pressured cultivators/zamindars. Financiers gained influence: **Jagat Seth banking house** guaranteed obligations and transmitted revenues to Delhi.
- Revenue contractors and financiers helped form a new provincial elite. **Permanent Settlement, 1793**, later consolidated a different colonial zamindari order; it was not introduced by Murshid Quli.
- Formal Mughal allegiance survived; tribute became increasingly irregular. “Independent Nawab” describes effective autonomy, not a complete legal break with the emperor.



Revenue, administration and banking reinforced provincial authority.

4. Bengal rulers: succession to Plassey

- **Murshid Quli Khan (1717–27) → son-in-law Shuja-ud-Din (1727–39) → Shuja's son Sarfaraz (1739–40)**.

- **Alivardi Khan (1740–56):** Bihar deputy governor; defeated/killed Sarfaraz at **Giria, 1740** with support from powerful provincial interests, including bankers. Appointment and remittance links to Delhi weakened further.
- Faced **Maratha/Bargi raids in the 1740s** and Afghan challenge under **Mustafa Khan**. **1751 settlement:** Orissa passed under Maratha control; annual Bengal/Bihar chauth **₹12 lakh**, not the chapter's ₹1.2 lakh figure. West Bengal district history
- Murshid Quli/Alivardi promoted commerce, maintained law/order and used officials across communities. Alivardi restricted French/English fortification; repeated warfare means his entire reign cannot be labelled uninterrupted peace.
- **Siraj-ud-Daulah (1756–57):** Alivardi's grandson; rival claims of **Shaukat Jung, Purnea**, and **Ghaseti Begum** intensified court divisions.
- Important actors: **Jagat Seths, Mir Jafar, Rai Durlabh, Raj Ballabh, Umichand/Amir Chand**; their roles/interests were not identical.
- Company conflict: abuse/disputes over **1717 farman privileges**, unauthorised strengthening of **Fort William**, and interference in local politics.
- **Plassey, 23 June 1757:** Company under Clive defeated Siraj through military action and court conspiracy/non-cooperation, especially Mir Jafar. Commercial influence became political power; detailed conquest follows in later chapters.

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5. Awadh: Nawab-Wazirs, finance and culture

- **Saadat Khan / Burhan-ul-Mulk (1722–39):** Irani/Shia founder; governor appointed by Muhammad Shah. Subdued rebellious zamindars, reorganised revenue **1723**, built a paid army and hereditary provincial authority.
- Secured deputy position for nephew/son-in-law **Safdar Jung**; expanded influence towards Kora, Banaras, Jaunpur and adjoining areas. Captured at **Karnal, 1739**; became entangled in Nadir's demands and died that year.
- **Safdar Jung / Abul Mansur Khan (1739–54):** Awadh successor; imperial **wazir from 1748**, also associated with Allahabad. Hence **Nawab-Wazirs**. Used Maratha alliances, restrained rebellious chiefs and employed Hindus, including **Maharaja Nawab Rai**.
- **Shuja-ud-Daulah (1754–75):** sided with **Abdali at Panipat, 1761**; joined **Mir Qasim + Shah Alam II against Company at Buxar, 1764**.
- **Allahabad treaty, 1765:** Awadh restored to Shuja with indemnity **₹50 lakh** and Company arrangements; subsequent troop payments increased dependence. **1773 arrangement:** chapter records **₹2.1 lakh monthly per brigade**.
- **Asaf-ud-Daulah (1775–97):** shifted capital **Faizabad → Lucknow, 1775**; patronised literature/arts; **Bara Imambara, 1784**. Delhi writers such as **Sauda and Mir Hasan** found regional patrons.
- Awadh served as Company buffer; growing subsidies and territorial pressure eroded autonomy. **Annexed 1856**.
- Distinguish **Saadatullah—Carnatic; Saadat Khan—Awadh; Shuja-ud-Din—Bengal; Shuja-ud-Daulah—Awadh; Asaf Jah—Hyderabad; Asaf-ud-Daulah—Awadh**.



Pair each successor State with its founder or administrative centre.

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6. Maratha background and institutions

- **Sambhaji executed, Shahu captured—1689; Rajaram resisted until 1700; Tarabai continued as regent for Shivaji II**. Shahu's release **1707** triggered conflict with Tarabai.
- **Balaji Vishwanath** helped Shahu establish authority; royal centre increasingly depended on Peshwa and sardars. **Fitna:** exploiting political grievances/factional divisions alongside warfare.
- **Chauth = 25% revenue claim; sardeshmukhi = additional 10%**. Political/revenue demands, not a uniform tax paid everywhere in India.
- **1719 Mughal sanad:** Balaji's assistance to Sayyid brothers secured recognition of Maratha claims in six Deccan subahs—**Aurangabad, Berar, Bidar, Bijapur, Hyderabad, Khandesh**. Associated obligations: **15,000 troops**, order in Deccan and tribute **₹10 lakh**. Remember as **"Magna Carta of Maratha dominion"**.
- Revenue/military assignments to sardars helped create the **confederacy**; hereditary control and independent forces later undermined coordination. **Watan and saranjam** had distinct local/hereditary and service-assignment backgrounds; do not equate every grant with absolute land ownership.
- Major houses: **Holkar—Indore; Scindia/Shinde—Gwalior; Gaekwad—Baroda; Bhonsle—Nagpur**; Peshwa centre **Poona/Pune**.

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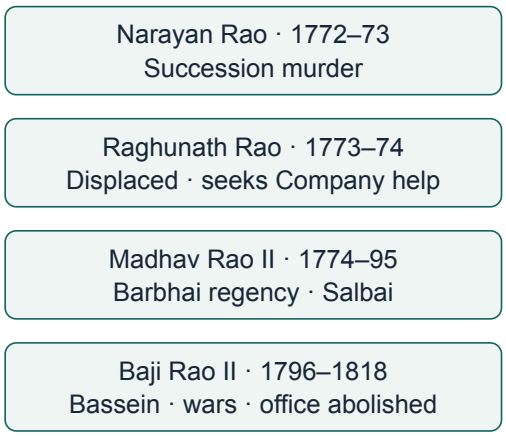
7. Peshwas: sequence and turning points

- **Balaji Vishwanath (1713–20):** appointed by Shahu; diplomacy, **1719 sanad**, confederacy foundation; **"second founder of Maratha State"**.
- **Baji Rao I (1720–40):** "fighting Peshwa"; rapid cavalry/guerilla campaigning; northward expansion into **Malwa, Gujarat, Bundelkhand**; Delhi raid **1737**; promoted **Hindu Pad-Padshahi** as political idiom.
- Defeated Nizam, attacked **Sidis from 1733** and Portuguese possessions. **Bassein captured in 1739 by Chimaji Appa**, Baji Rao's brother; do not attribute every campaign personally to Baji Rao.
- **Balaji Baji Rao / Nana Saheb (1740–61):** territorial influence reached **Cuttack to Attock**. After Shahu died **1749**, **Sangola arrangement, 1750**, associated with **Rajaram II/Ramraja**, consolidated Peshwa authority. Distinguish him from Shivaji's son Rajaram.
- **Raghuji Bhonsle's eastern raids → 1751 Bengal settlement**; pressure on Mysore/southern powers; northern advance culminated in Punjab occupation **1758** and confrontation with Abdali.

- **Madhav Rao I (1761–72):** revived power after Panipat—**Maratha Resurrection**; recovered influence against Nizam/Mysore and in north. **Nana Phadnavis and Mahadji Scindia** important partners; **1771–January 1772**, Shah Alam returned to Delhi. Madhav Rao died of tuberculosis **1772**.
- **Narayan Rao (1772–73):** murdered amid succession intrigue. **Raghunath Rao (1773–74)** briefly Peshwa; displaced by **Barbhai council of twelve**, led by Nana, including Scindia/Holkar interests.
- **Sawai Madhav Rao / Madhav Rao II (1774–95):** Narayan Rao's posthumous son, installed as infant; council/regency dominated politics. Raghunath sought Company help → **First Anglo-Maratha War, 1775–82**.
- **Salbai, 1782**, ended the first war through negotiated settlement; **not a straightforward British conquest/Maratha defeat**. Mahadji played a key military/diplomatic role. Maharashtra Gazetteer
- **Mahadji Scindia (1768–94):** northern reconstruction, Delhi influence, army trained with **Benoît de Boigne**. **Perron** later led Scindia's European brigades under successor **Daulat Rao**; do not place all his service under Mahadji.
- **Baji Rao II (1796–1818):** last Peshwa. Nana died **1800**; Holkar defeated Peshwa/Scindia at **Poona, 1802**, following conflict including killing of **Vithoji Holkar, 1801**.
- Peshwa fled and accepted **Treaty of Bassein, 1802**, subsidiary alliance → **Second Anglo-Maratha War, 1803–05**. **Third war, 1817–18:** surrendered **1818**, office abolished, pensioned at **Bithoor**.
- **Nana Saheb of 1857 = adopted son of Baji Rao II**; different from **Balaji Baji Rao/Nana Saheb** and **Nana Phadnavis**.



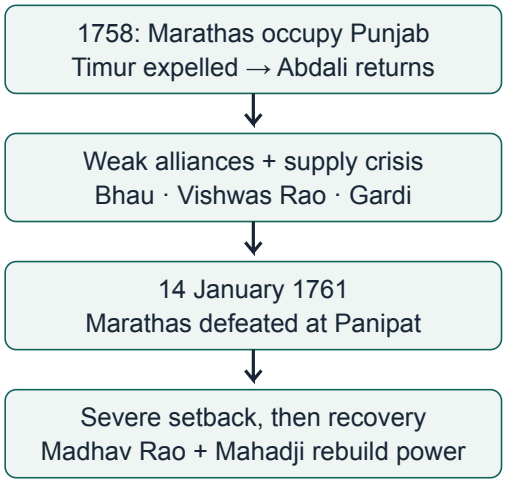
Early Peshwas: diplomacy, expansion, setback and recovery.



Later succession conflicts opened the confederacy to Company intervention.

8. Third Panipat: cause, defeat and consequence

- **Immediate trigger:** Marathas expelled Abdali's representative/son **Timur Shah from Lahore/Punjab, 1758**; Abdali returned to reverse their ascendancy.
- **14 January 1761:** Abdali with **Najib-ud-Daulah/Rohillas and Shuja-ud-Daulah** versus Marathas led by **Sadashiv Rao Bhau**, with **Vishwas Rao**; **Ibrahim Khan Gardi** commanded trained infantry/artillery.
- Defeat factors: weak northern alliances; loss of Suraj Mal's active support; cut supply routes/starvation; burdensome non-combatant train; command disagreements; effective Afghan cavalry/firearms and coordination.
- Army/casualty estimates vary; the chapter's **60,000 versus 45,000** and very large civilian totals are estimates. **Marathas did possess firearms/artillery**—not merely swords and lances. Neither army represented one religion exclusively.
- Bhau/Vishwas Rao killed; Peshwa Balaji died **June 1761**. Losses checked imperial expansion and indirectly helped Company consolidation.
- **Not the final disappearance of Maratha power:** Madhav Rao/Mahadji rebuilt influence. Abdali did not establish enduring direct rule over all India; Panipat did not by itself determine a British victory.



Panipat checked expansion but did not end Maratha political power.

9. Sikhs: Gurus and political consolidation

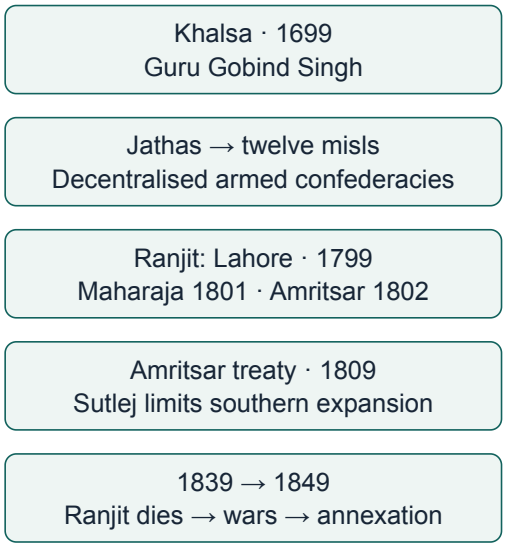
- **Guru sequence:** Nanak → Angad → Amar Das → Ram Das → Arjan → Hargobind → Har Rai → Har Krishan → Tegh Bahadur → Gobind Singh.
- **Nanak:** devotional equality, foundation of Sikh community; **Angad:** Gurmukhi development, education/physical training and strengthening community kitchen. Langar developed across early Gurus; not an isolated invention by one later Guru.
- **Amar Das:** Anand Sahib, social reform and strengthening langar; opposed discriminatory practices/sati. **Ram Das:** Ramdaspur/Amritsar and sacred tank; **Arjan:** Adi Granth compilation, Harmandir construction completed; executed **1606**.
- **Hargobind:** martial organisation, **Akal Takht**, temporal/spiritual leadership; **Har Rai:** maintained armed followers while avoiding major conflict; **Har Krishan:** became Guru aged five.
- **Tegh Bahadur:** executed at Delhi **1675**; **Gobind Singh:** became Guru aged nine, founded **Khalsa, 1699**, died **1708**. His four sons were killed in Mughal-era conflicts.

- Khalsa's **five Ks:** kesh, kangha, kara, kirpan, kachhera; community/Granth authority outlasted the line of human Gurus. Political militarisation also reflected agrarian mobilisation and struggles over authority.
- **Banda Singh Bahadur / Banda Bairagi (1708–16):** armed resistance; captured **1715**, executed **1716**. Resistance survived repression/internal divisions.
- Mughal decline, Nadir/Abdali invasions, Maratha incursions and provincial succession conflict—including after **Zakariya Khan's death, 1745**—opened opportunities.
- **Jathas → misls:** mobile armed groups consolidated into **twelve confederacies**; not only blood-kin groups. Examples **Bhangi, Ramgarhia, Kanhaiya, Singhpuria, Ahluwalia, Sukerchakia**; cooperation coexisted with decentralisation.

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10. Ranjit Singh and Punjab

- **Ranjit Singh:** son of **Mahan Singh**, Sukerchakia chief; took leadership **1792**, **Lahore 1799**, Maharaja **1801**, **Amritsar 1802**. **Sher-e-Punjab**.
- **Amritsar treaty, 1809:** constrained expansion south of **Sutlej**; cis-Sutlej chiefs came under British protection. Did not recognise his rule over every Punjab territory without limit.
- North/west expansion: **Multan, Kashmir, Peshawar**; modernised army with European instructors; diverse Sikh, Muslim, Hindu, Dogra, Gorkha and other recruits.
- Retained/adapted existing revenue arrangements; chapter quotes demand around **half produce**, but rates varied. **Fakir Azizuddin and Diwan Dina Nath** were trusted officials; patronised different religious traditions and gilding of Harmandir.
- **Tripartite Treaty, 1838:** Ranjit + Company + Afghan **Shah Shuja**, linked to restoration attempt in Afghanistan. Do not infer unrestricted British passage across Punjab from the treaty label.
- Ranjit died **1839**; **Kharak Singh and Nau Nihal Singh died 1840**, not 1839. Succession conflict weakened the kingdom; **First Anglo-Sikh War 1845–46; annexation 1849** after second war. Historical records
- Sikh dynastic identity coexisted with religiously diverse administration; “not a Sikh State” should not erase its Sikh political foundations.



Sikh mobilisation developed from community institutions to a centralised kingdom.

11. Jats and Afghan principalities

- **Jats—Delhi–Agra belt:** agrarian revolts and zamindar leadership. **Churaman—Thun fort; Badan Singh—Deeg, Kumher, Weir, Bharatpur consolidation; Suraj Mal (1756–63)—zenith**.
- Suraj Mal combined diplomacy/administration, called **“Plato of the Jats” / “Jat Ulysses”**. His domain included areas around Agra, Mathura, Aligarh and Meerut; revenue demands could be heavy despite peasant origins.
- **Panipat:** withdrew active support after differences with Bhau; did not fight the battle, but sheltered/helped survivors. Loss of access to Jat supplies aggravated Maratha difficulties.
- Suraj Mal died fighting Rohillas **1763**; **Bharatpur survived his death**—do not treat this as extinction of the kingdom.
- **Farrukhabad:** founded **1714**, named after Farrukhsiyar, by **Muhammad Khan Bangash**; **Ahmad Khan Bangash was his successor/son**, not another name for the founder. District history
- **Rohilkhand: Ali Muhammad Khan**, linked with Daud Khan, consolidated Afghan authority; centre **Aonla**. **Rampur** later emerged as a successor principality; not a simple simultaneous capital of one unchanged State.
- Rohilla/Bangash interests interacted with Abdali, Awadh, Jats, Marathas and Company. Rohilkhand was **not founded from territories conquered by Abdali**.

12. Mysore: Hyder and Tipu

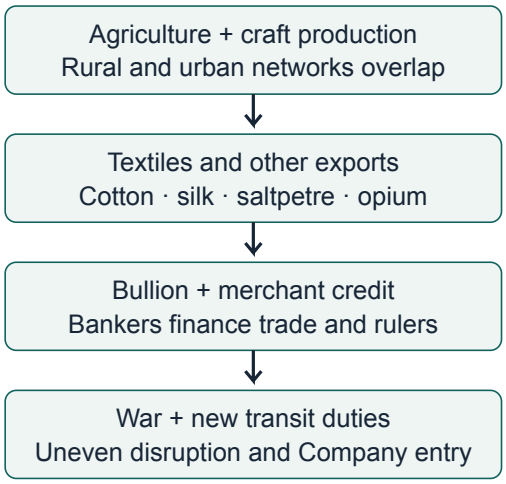
- **Vijayanagara background → Wodeyar/Wadiyar kingdom**; early eighteenth-century court dominated by **Nanjaraja and Devaraja**. **Hyder Ali** rose through army and took effective control **1761**; Wodeyar monarchy initially retained.
- **Hyder (1761–82):** subdued poligars, expanded into **Bednur, Sunda, Sira, Canara, Malabar**, sought coastal access. Faced Marathas/Nizam/Company; pressure on Madras led to **1769 treaty**.
- French-assisted **Dindigul arsenal, 1755**; trained forces/rissalas and stronger command. Many Hindu officials; died **1782 during Second Anglo-Mysore War**.
- **Tipu Sultan (1782–99):** asserted Padshah status **1787**, issued own coinage/calendar and khutba, sought Ottoman recognition; used Mughal legitimacy selectively.
- Military: French training, firearms/artillery and **naval effort in 1790s**. Economic policy: State-supervised trade, factories for **silk, sugar, paper, tools**, agricultural improvement/sericulture; missions to **France, Ottoman lands, Iran, Pegu** and trading-company experiments.
- Administration concentrated in Sultan; chapter departmental names: **Mir Asaf—revenue/finance; Mir Miran—military; Malik-ut-Tujjar—commerce; Mir Yam—marine; Mir Khazain—treasury/mint; Mir Sadar—ordnance/garrisons**.
- Associated with French **Jacobin/“Citizen Tipu” and Tree of Liberty** episode; distinguish political symbolism from democratic constitutional government. **Sringeri correspondence** records temple support; assess policies regionally rather than through blanket colonial or heroic labels.
- Died defending **Srirangapatnam, 1799**, Fourth Anglo-Mysore War. Four wars across Hyder/Tipu: **1767–69, 1780–84, 1790–92, 1799**; rival Indian powers sometimes aligned with Company.

13. Kerala and Rajputs

- Kerala's major polities: **Calicut/Zamorin, Chirakkal, Cochin, Travancore**. Hyder's **1766 Malabar expansion** did not absorb Travancore.
- **Marthanda Varma (1729–58):** consolidated Travancore, western-trained army; **Colachel, 1741**, defeated Dutch. **Rama Varma/Dharma Raja (1758–98):** scholarship, arts and outward-looking court; capital **Padmanabhapuram → Thiruvananthapuram, 1795**; Company influence intensified around **1800**. Thiruvananthapuram history
- **Rajputs:** Mughal mansabs/tribute and local autonomy; Marwar succession dispute over **Ajit Singh**, posthumous son of **Jaswant Singh**, aggravated relations. **Durgadas Rathore** important in resistance; alliances involving Marwar, Amber and Mewar renewed autonomy **1708**.
- Ajit Singh/Jai Singh manoeuvred between Delhi factions for governorships; rivalries prevented a durable collective challenge to Marathas/Company.
- **Sawai Jai Singh II (1699–1743):** founded **Jaipur, 1727**, planned streets; five observatories **Delhi, Jaipur, Ujjain, Banaras, Mathura**; **Zij Muhammadshahi** tables, Sanskrit scientific translations including Euclidean geometry; sought to restrain extravagant wedding costs linked with female infanticide.

14. Economy: villages, manufactures and trade

- Village economy combined cultivation, household spinning/weaving and service crafts; artisans received grain/payments. **Patil/headman and panchayat** handled local affairs/collections, but external markets, merchants and State power mattered.
- Reject absolute **"unchanging, fully isolated, collectively owned everywhere"** model: hereditary, communal, individual and intermediary rights varied. Revenue demand also varied; chapter's one-sixth–one-third is not universal. NCERT: agrarian rights and revenue
- Constraints: high extraction, war disruption, limited investment, caste restrictions and unequal access to resources. Regional agricultural/commercial growth contradicts uniform stagnation.
- **Textiles:** Bengal—Dhaka/Murshidabad; Gujarat—Ahmedabad/Surat/Bharuch; Coromandel—Masulipatnam and coastal centres. **Aurangabad is Deccan, not Andhra**. Silk—Murshidabad/Lahore/Agra; shawls/carpets—Kashmir/Lahore/Agra.
- Other centres: **Patna, Chanderi, Burhanpur, Banaras, Jaunpur, Lucknow, Multan, Bangalore, Coimbatore, Madurai**. Rural industry and urban commerce overlapped.
- Products: **indigo, sugar, oils, tobacco, opium, metalwork/jewellery, luxury crafts, shipbuilding**. Mining/technology had limitations, but manufactures had international demand.
- Merchant finance: **shroffs, mahajans, chetties, Jagat Seths** supported credit/remittance.
- **Exports:** cotton textiles foremost; silk, indigo, saltpetre, grain, sugar, spices, stones/drugs. Company Bengal staples: **cotton, silk, saltpetre, opium**.
- **Imports by route:** Gulf—pearls/silk/wool/dates; Arabia—coffee/gold/drugs; China—tea/porcelain/silk; Tibet—gold/musk/wool; Indonesian islands—spices; Africa—ivory; Europe—metals/woollens/paper.
- Strong textile exports drew **bullion inflows**; favourable trade balance did not imply no imports. Wars/plunder, multiplying transit duties and Company intervention disrupted routes unevenly.



Commercial strength coexisted with political and fiscal disruption.

15. Society, education and cultural continuity

- Unequal society: ruling/noble elites, merchants and vast peasant/artisan population; caste/class, religion, language and region shaped status. Muslim society also had class/status divisions; communities were not internally uniform.
- Patriarchy, child marriage, dowry, purdah, sati and restricted widow opportunities; polygamy more feasible among wealthy. **Nair matriliny** is a qualification, not proof of universal female equality in Kerala.
- Slavery/dependent labour persisted; poverty/famine and trading networks sustained trafficking. Do not romanticise “better-treated slaves/free children everywhere” or treat **1789 restrictions as complete all-India abolition**.
- **Pathshalas/maktabs:** elementary reading/writing/arithmetic and religious/moral learning. **Tols/chatuspathis:** Sanskrit; **madrasas:** Arabic/Persian. Persian learned across religious communities; **Bernier—Banaras as Athens of India**.
- Access unequal by gender/caste/wealth; vocational learning through household/craft networks. Avoid blanket claims of no mathematics/science or accurately measured universal literacy superiority; education varied by region.
- Everyday cooperation, shared festivals and Urdu encouraged composite culture, alongside political conflicts; neither universal harmony nor universal hostility explains the period.
- Patronage moved **Delhi → Lucknow, Hyderabad, Murshidabad, Jaipur**. **Bara Imambara 1784; Jaipur/observatories; Harmandir gilding under Ranjit; Padmanabhapuram palace/murals** show continuing creativity.
- Urdu: **Mir, Sauda, Nazir**; **Ghalib mainly nineteenth-century**, not an established eighteenth-century poet. Vernacular growth: Malayalam **Kunchan Nambiar**, Kathakali; Sindhi **Shah Abdul Latif/Risalo, Sachal, Sami**; Punjabi **Waris Shah/Heer**; Assamese under **Ahoms**; Gujarati **Dayaram**, spanning late eighteenth/early nineteenth centuries.

16. Why regional powers could not collectively resist Company

- Rival ambitions, succession/factional conflicts and unstable alliances; revenue extraction often outweighed integrated administration of distant conquests.

- Uneven fiscal/military organisation and access to technology, Company credit/revenue base, trained forces and diplomacy mattered—not a universal absence of Indian innovation.
- **Mysore, Scindia's brigades, Ranjit's army and Jai Singh's science** directly qualify the chapter's broad “total scientific ignorance” argument.
- **Satish Chandra:** provincial resources/new wealth could weaken imperial centralisation; political fragmentation was not synonymous with general economic collapse.
- Mains balance: regional State-building and cultural growth **plus** fragmented coordination and Company opportunities; avoid treating conquest as predetermined.

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17. PYQ revision and Mains framework

- **2000—Maratha administration after Sambhaji: Balaji Vishwanath (b)**.
- **2001—modern foreign embassies: Tipu Sultan (d)**; link diplomacy with trade/military policy.
- **2010—Abdali's immediate Panipat trigger: expulsion of Timur from Lahore by Marathas (a)**.
- **2018—Company Bengal exports: cotton, silk, saltpetre, opium (d)**; remember **C–S–S–O**.
- **2021—origins of kingdoms: Arcot from Hyderabad and Mysore from Vijayanagara correct; Rohilkhand from Abdali's territories incorrect → (a), 1 and 2**.
- **Mains 2017:** “Clarify how mid-eighteenth century India was beset with the spectre of a fragmented polity.” Structure: declining effective Mughal command → three kinds of regional power with examples → factional/territorial rivalry, fluid alliances and European intervention → conclude that political fragmentation coexisted with administrative, economic and cultural continuity.